What Is an IT Consultant? (Plus How To Become One)

Written by Indeed Editorial Team

Updated June 16, 2026

On this page

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- One common job title in information technology is an IT consultant, who typically works with organizations or institutions that use technology systems for their business operations.
- An IT consultant is a professional who assists clients with technology projects; this involves providing recommendations on new technologies, software and devices based on clients' needs.
- To become an IT consultant, you will generally need a degree in a relevant field, professional experience through entry-level IT jobs or internships, and certification to set yourself apart from other candidates.

A career in information technology can provide opportunities to collaborate with people frequently and offer advice about technology use to companies and organizations. One common job title in information technology is an IT consultant, who typically works with organizations or institutions that use technology systems for their business operations. You might thrive in a career as an IT consultant if you have an interest in technology and enjoy working with others. In this article, we define what an IT consultant is and explore how to become one.

Key takeaways:

- An IT consultant is a professional who assists clients with technology projects; this involves providing recommendations on new technologies, software and devices based on clients' needs.
- To become an IT consultant, you will generally need a degree in a relevant field, professional experience through entry-level IT jobs or internships, and certification to set yourself apart from other candidates.
- The key skills for this role include attention to detail, problem solving, critical thinking, and time management, as well as technical knowledge and proficiency in technical repairs.

Find your next job more quickly

Job seekers who use Indeed Career Scout are 38% more likely to get hired

Try Career Scout

Source: Indeed test data, US, May 2025, based on the average hires per apply

INSIGHTS FROM INDEED

IT Analyst Hiring Insights

Average pay

$98,743 / year

Low $16,000 **High** $255,000

Job seekers

31,958

+105 since August 2026

Employers hiring

596

+596 with open roles this month

Based on Indeed data · Refreshed monthly

See 1,108 open IT Analyst jobs →

What is an IT consultant?

An IT consultant is a technology professional who supports clients during technological projects. Many IT consultants work for companies or businesses that need guidance when making decisions about the technology they use. An IT consultant can find work by joining an IT consultancy firm, or they might operate as independent contractors and choose their own projects. Because technology is continuously changing, IT consultants can provide their clients with updates about new technology as it becomes available and recommend new devices or software based on their clients' needs.

Related jobs on Indeed

- Technical support jobs ›
- Computer Technician jobs ›
- IT Auditor jobs ›
- IT Analyst jobs ›

View more jobs on Indeed →

What does an IT consultant do?

An IT consultant is responsible for helping businesses and organizations manage their technology use. This can involve assessing elements of a company's computer systems like cybersecurity, software performance and data and analytics that can affect how a business might benefit from the technology they use. IT consultants spend a large portion of their job meeting with clients to discuss the next steps they plan to take in updating and maintaining their technology, where they can offer advice about which new technological developments might contribute to their success.

An IT consultant might also perform repairs on IT systems and technological devices that companies need to conduct business.

Work environment for IT consultants

The work environment for an IT consultant typically depends on the client that they're serving. For example, if they work with a company that has its own office building, they might spend time there for meetings and assessments and complete any technical projects at an offsite location. IT consultants who are independent contractors might complete some of their work from home, as they can conduct phone calls, perform research and write technology recommendations for companies from their personal computers and devices. An IT consultant might also work at a consultancy firm with teams of other IT consultants.

Related: Learn About The Information Technology Field

How to become an IT consultant

Here's how you can start your career as an IT consultant:

1. Earn a degree

Enroll in a degree program with an accredited college or university. While some IT consultants might be able to find work with a high school diploma or GED equivalent, most companies require IT consultants to have at least a bachelor's degree. Many aspiring IT consultants choose to major in computer science, IT or software engineering so that they can gain the skills and training they need to succeed in the field. However, you might also decide to major in a related subject like electronic engineering, business studies or mathematics.

2. Gain professional experience

Apply for entry-level jobs in information technology after you graduate with your bachelor's degree. This can allow you to build your expertise and develop your skills through professional experience in the field. You might apply for a job as an IT assistant, entry-level software engineer or computer technician to enter the industry and learn about which career paths are most interesting to you. This stage can also introduce you to various industries, which can help you in your work as an IT consultant by determining which industries you enjoy working with.

Another option is to find an apprenticeship or internship with a working IT consultant, which can give you the education and training you need by observing a professional in the field and engaging in practical work.

Related: 10 Jobs in Information Technology (With Descriptions)

3. Obtain certification

Apply for certification as an IT professional. Certification is often voluntary for IT consultants, but having certification can make you stand out among other candidates who are not certified and might increase your chances of being hired. Most certifications in information technology involve completing coursework and training and many require candidates to have a certain number of years of professional experience before they apply. Here are a few certifications you might pursue as an IT consultant:

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
- SANS GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)
- Project Management Professional (PMP)

4. Apply for work as an IT consultant

Search for job openings for IT consultants and apply to any that seem like a good fit for you. One great way to find work as an IT consultant is to reach out to IT consulting firms to inquire about any openings they might have. Working for an IT consulting firm can connect you to potential clients as well as other IT professionals. You might also want to work as an independent contractor, which can require you to find clients who need an IT consultant through internet searches, cold calls and email communications.

Skills that an IT consultant needs

Here are some common skills that IT consultants need for their jobs:

- Proficiency in technical repairs
- Current knowledge of technological advancements
- Attention to detail
- Problem-solving skills
- Critical thinking skills

- Effective time management
- Interpersonal and communication skills

Related: Information Technology Skills That Are In-Demand Today

Search jobs and companies hiring now

Job title, keywords or company

Location

Search

Salary and job outlook for IT consultants

As there are a few different job titles IT consultants can hold, Indeed lists various salaries for IT consultants. Many IT consultants also qualify for benefits outside of their competitive salaries, such as health insurance, paid time off and a flexible spending account. Here are a few national average salaries for IT consultants in the United States:

- **IT analyst:** $78,617 per year
- **Implementation consultant:** $81,753 per year
- **IT auditor:** $97,834 per year
- **Salesforce consultant:** $105,175 per year

The Bureau of Labor Statistics also lists the job outlooks for various job titles that IT consultants can hold. For example, the Bureau of Labor Statistics expects the number of people employed as information security analysts to grow by 31% from 2019 to 2029, which is an exceptionally high rate of growth. The Bureau also states that employment for computer and information systems managers could grow by 10% from 2019 to 2029, which is also fairly rapid.

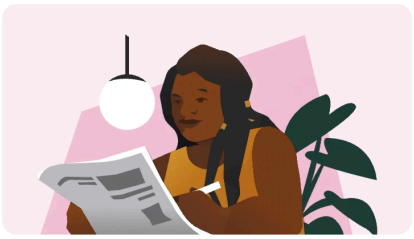
Another example from the Bureau of Labor Statistics is the job title of computer support specialist, which they predict could grow by 8% from 2019 to 2029.

The information on this site is provided as a courtesy and for informational purposes only. Indeed is not a career or legal advisor and does not guarantee job interviews or offers.

Technical support

Share:

Related Articles



Software Consultant: What It Is and How To Become One



Types of IT Jobs (With Duties and Salaries)



What Is an IT Specialist? Plus Duties and How To Become One

1 / 4

Explore more articles

How To Write Effective Cold Emails for Jobs (With Template and Examples)

A Guide to Executive Business Titles: Meanings and Hierarchy

24 Side Jobs for Military Members (With Salaries and Duties)

5 Types of Civil Engineering (With 14 Jobs To Explore)

How To Write a Grant Proposal in 9 Steps (With Definition)

What Is Transformational Leadership? (And How To Lead With Motivation)

How To Respond to a Job Rejection Email (With Examples)

How Does a Holding Company Operate? Pros, Cons and Example

26 Narrative Techniques for Writers (With Examples)

26 Ways To Start a Speech and Capture People's Attention

11 Jobs for Professionals Who Are Deaf or Hard of Hearing

25 Effective Business Tips for Success and Achieving Your Goals

Countries
About
Help
ESG at Indeed
Download app
© 2026 Indeed
Your Privacy Choices
Accessibility at Indeed
Privacy Center and Ad Choices
Terms